

CORNELL NOTES

Student Handout • Fundamentals of Study and Employability

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A simple rule to remember

Use the right-hand column for the information you collect during a lesson or reading. Afterward, review your notes and add short prompts in the left-hand column. Complete the summary at the end.

1. What goes in each column?

CUE COLUMN • 25%	NOTES COLUMN • 75%
Added mainly AFTER the lesson: • Keywords • Main ideas • Important terms • Headings • Questions • Memory triggers	Written DURING the lesson or reading: • Definitions • Explanations • Key facts • Examples • Processes or steps • Important details

2. How to make Cornell Notes

1. Prepare the page and write the topic, date and research question.
2. Record meaningful information in the Notes Column. Do not copy every word.
3. Review the notes and identify what matters most.
4. Use the detailed notes to create short cues. Include keywords, main ideas, important terms, headings, questions and memory triggers.
5. Recite by covering the Notes Column and answering from the cues.
6. Summarise the complete topic in 3–5 sentences using your own words.
7. Review the page regularly.

Important

Keep the Cue Column brief. It should help you remember or test yourself. Put the fuller definitions, explanations, facts, examples, steps and supporting details in the Notes Column.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Topic: Time Management for University Students

CUE COLUMN • ADD AFTER	NOTES COLUMN • WRITE DURING/READING
Time management [Keyword]	Definition: Planning and organising time so tasks and goals can be completed.
Effective planning improves study [Main idea]	Explanation: Planning helps students meet deadlines, reduce stress and balance responsibilities.
Procrastination [Important term]	Definition: Delaying a task even when the delay may create negative consequences.
Useful time-management methods [Heading]	Key facts and examples: weekly timetable, calendar, prioritised task list and deadline reminders.
How can students manage a large assignment? [Question]	Process: check the deadline → divide the assignment into smaller tasks → schedule each task → monitor progress.
Plan → Prioritise → Complete [Memory trigger]	Important detail: The three words remind the student to organise work, decide what matters first and finish it.
Summary Time management helps university students organise tasks, meet deadlines and reduce stress. Students can use timetables, prioritised task lists and smaller milestones to manage their work. Regular planning makes academic goals easier to complete.	

RESEARCH-BASED CORNELL NOTES EXAMPLE

The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on the Future of Employment in the Computing Industry

Research question

How is artificial intelligence likely to change computing jobs, required skills and the role of human workers?

How to read this example: The left side shows the **type of cue used**. The right side shows the **fuller information collected from the research**.

CUE COLUMN • ADDED AFTER RESEARCH	NOTES COLUMN • RECORDED DURING RESEARCH
Artificial Intelligence (AI) [Keyword]	Definition: AI refers to computer systems designed to perform tasks associated with human intelligence, including learning, reasoning and decision-making. Explanation: AI is increasingly used in computing products, services and workplace processes.
AI is transforming computing jobs [Main idea]	Key fact: AI and information-processing technologies are expected to transform many organisations by 2030. Important detail: Computing work is likely to change as AI becomes part of software development, data analysis, cybersecurity and other workflows. [Source 1]
Generative AI [Important term]	Definition: Generative AI produces new content, such as text, code or images, in response to instructions. Key fact: The ILO reports that most exposed jobs are more likely to be transformed than made redundant because human input remains necessary. [Source 2]
Skills required for future employment [Heading]	Key facts: AI and big data, networks and cybersecurity, and technological literacy are identified as rapidly growing skill areas. Important detail: Employers surveyed by the World Economic Forum expect 39% of workers' core skills to change by 2030. [Sources 1 and 3]
How will AI affect computing employment? [Question]	Explanation: AI may automate or support selected tasks rather than remove every part of a job. Example: A software professional may use AI to draft code, then review, test, secure and integrate the output. This is a practical example based on the research.
AI ≠ job loss only [Memory trigger]	Important detail: AI can create opportunities and risks at the same time. Some routine tasks may be automated, while demand may increase for AI knowledge, cybersecurity, data skills, oversight and responsible decision-making. [Sources 1 and 2]

AI AND EMPLOYMENT

Cornell Notes Example • Continued

CUE COLUMN • ADDED AFTER RESEARCH	NOTES COLUMN • RECORDED DURING RESEARCH
Automation [Keyword]	Definition: Automation is the use of technology to complete tasks with reduced human involvement. Example: AI may assist with code generation, software testing, documentation and repeated data-processing activities.
Tasks change, not only job titles [Main idea]	Explanation: Exposure to AI does not automatically mean that an entire occupation disappears. A role contains different tasks, and many still require context, accountability, communication and human judgement. [Source 2]
Reskilling [Important term]	Definition: Reskilling means learning new capabilities so a person can perform changing or different work. Process: identify skill gaps → select training → practise → apply the skill in projects → review progress.
Opportunities and risks [Heading]	Opportunities: improved productivity, new AI-related work and demand for technical skills. Risks: task displacement, rapid skill change, unreliable outputs, bias, security concerns and poorly managed transitions. [Sources 1 and 2]
What skills will employers require? [Question]	Key facts: Technology skills remain important, but analytical thinking, creative thinking, resilience, flexibility and agility are also highlighted. [Source 1] Important detail: Computing professionals need technical ability together with communication, judgement and adaptability.
Learn → Adapt → Thrive [Memory trigger]	Process for students: learn computing fundamentals → develop AI, data and cybersecurity literacy → evaluate AI outputs critically → communicate findings → keep updating skills throughout a career.
Summary Artificial intelligence is changing the computing industry by altering the way many tasks are completed. Some routine activities may be automated, but many roles are more likely to change than disappear completely because human judgement is still needed. Future computing professionals will need technical knowledge alongside problem-solving, communication, adaptability and responsible decision-making. Students should therefore learn how to use AI tools effectively while continuing to strengthen their core computing skills.	

References for the AI example

- World Economic Forum (2025), The Future of Jobs Report 2025.
- International Labour Organization (2025), Generative AI and jobs: A 2025 update.
- World Economic Forum (2025), The Future of Jobs Report 2025: Skills Outlook.

Before you finish

- ☐ Cues follow the required categories
- ☐ Notes contain details, not single words
- ☐ Information is paraphrased
- ☐ Sources are labelled
- ☐ The summary answers the research question

BLANK CORNELL NOTES TEMPLATE

Use for a lesson, reading, video or research activity

Topic: _____

Research question: _____

Date: _____ Student: _____

CUE COLUMN • ADD AFTER

NOTES COLUMN • WRITE DURING/READING

SUMMARY • 3–5 sentences in your own words